

Democratic Republic of the Congo



Africa



Simple but sturdy

In some parts of the country, young people earn their livelihood delivering goods using a reliable handmade vehicle called a chukudu.

This inexpensive two-wheeler is made from wood and recycled materials.

ATLANTIC OCEAN



Sociable apes

Found only in the lush rain forests along the Congo River, these bonobo apes live in peaceful communities of 30–100 individuals.



- 📏 905,355 sq miles (2,344,858 sq km)
- 👤 101.8 million
- ★ Kinshasa
- 🗣️ Kiswahili, Tshiluba, other languages (+3)

Previously called Zaire, the Democratic Republic of the Congo is the **second-largest country** in Africa. It straddles the **equator** so at the same time that it is **spring in the north** of the country, it is **fall in the south**.



0 200 km
0 200 miles
(approximate scale)

Ornate drum

A tradition of the Vili people, who live across Central Africa, is to sculpt these unique drums, mounted on top of intricately carved figures.



The human figurine supporting the drum is sitting on a leopard.



Musical metropolis

Home to more than 11 million people and growing rapidly, Kinshasa is the cradle of Congolese rumba dance music.



Mount Nyiragongo

This active volcano in the Great Rift Valley last erupted in 2002. A lake of lava has formed inside the volcano's crater.

Ingenious fishermen

Near Kisangani the Wagenya people catch fish in sievelike baskets attached to poles suspended over the Congo River rapids.

